



PROGRESS REPORT

Digital Payments and Fintech: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-27

Edition of 2026-08-27-3 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

3 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA · WEST AFRICA

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
Association of African Central Banks (AACB)	No decision of the Assembly on continental payment harmonisation held	A list of 54 decisions, of which decision 21 rules that the Payment Systems Directive for Africa is not to be led by an entity external to central banks and directs its own task force to lead the work	ADVANCED
Banks and countries connected to PAPSS	28 banks within nine months of launch, against an ambition of all 500 to 600 African banks (2022)	28 countries and over 190 banks and financial-technology firms connected, with the Central African central bank acceding in July 2026 and the West African central bank's pilot pending; connecting the EAC, West, Central and Southern African regional systems is put at reaching more than 60% of African countries, and no continent-wide transaction value is published (2026-08)	ADVANCED
CARICOM Payment and Settlement System (CAPSS)	Did not exist; modelled on PAPSS since CARICOM governors' unanimous October 2023 selection	Proof of concept complete in two countries; the ECCB Governor says at least two more central banks are needed for the initial pilot; not commercially operational, with settlement, FX, liquidity, AML and interoperability arrangements unresolved	ADVANCED
Fintech volume carried by the continent's largest operator	None published on this basis	13.0 billion transactions carrying US\$330.5bn in the half, up 17.2% in volume and 33.8% in value in constant currency, on 70.8 million monthly active mobile-money users	ADVANCED
Pan-African Payment and Settlement System (PAPSS)	Operating from January 2022 across West and East African cores, with no Central African central bank participating	Extended into Central Africa by the BEAC's accession, wired into a national switch in Kenya for the first time, and carrying a wallet-based Nigeria-to-Ghana rail settled in naira	ADVANCED
PAPSSCARD	Did not exist	A continental card scheme launched to route African card payments inside the continent rather than through global networks; no issuance, volume or country coverage held	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
UnionPay online acceptance through Standard Bank	A collaboration between the two parties dating from 2024, with no merchant count published	Online-payment acceptance for nearly 900 merchants across Botswana, Ghana, Kenya, Malawi, Namibia, Tanzania, Uganda, Zambia and Zimbabwe, settling in local currency, US dollars or both, against a stated African footprint of about 7 million UnionPay cards issued	ADVANCED
African take-up of China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System	Baseline not held	Reported as spreading across African banks as an alternative to Swift, smoothing trade settlement and potentially easing exposure to dollar sanctions, with Libyan banks set to join after talks between the Central Bank of Libya and the People's Bank of China. No participant list, transaction volume or value is held	BASELINE NOT HELD
COMESA digital retail payments platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	The regional clearing house published the scheme rulebook setting operational and governance rules for instant low-cost cross-border retail payments, and a gender audit and strategy to 2030 drawn from research along the Malawi-Zambia corridor	Baseline not held
Cost of sending money within Africa	Baseline not held	Put at 8.78% of the amount sent against the SDG target of 3% (2026-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD
Payment Systems Directive for Africa (PSDA)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Directed to be led by central banks rather than an external entity, with the Assembly's own task force on payment system integration to lead harmonisation; no draft directive held	Baseline not held
Stablecoin settlement rails serving African cross-border payments	Not held	Described by a pan-African payments operator's product chief as moving from speculative use into the plumbing of remittances and business settlement, on the evidence of Mastercard's agreement to acquire BVNK at up to US\$1.8bn and Visa's stablecoin-card expansion through Stripe's Bridge into more than 100 countries, African markets among them; a first named African deployment is Flutterwave's tie-up with Caliza offering USD accounts with USDC and USDT conversion	BASELINE NOT HELD
Unmet trade finance demand	BASELINE NOT HELD	US\$74bn to US\$100bn of unmet trade finance demand, with commercial banks intermediating about 23% of the continent's trade against 40% over 2011 to 2019, and intra-African trade at US\$213.8bn in 2025 (2026-08)	Baseline not held

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
COMESA Digital Retail Payments Platform	Did not exist	Piloting between Malawi and Zambia, targeting settlement costs under 3% of value against about 8%	ADVANCED
SADC-RTGS	Settling in rand alone since 2013; 15 of 16 members participating	Second settlement currency live; more than 80 banks, R250.7bn settled a month	ADVANCED
Settlement currencies in the SADC-RTGS	One, the rand (since 2013)	Two, rand and kwanza; pula and metical named next, four more weighing onboarding by end-2027	ADVANCED
TCIB cross-border retail payment scheme	A South Africa-Botswana commitment of late 2024, no corridor live	Botswana corridor live through one bank, First Capital Bank Botswana	ADVANCED

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
BCEAO connection obligation for instant-payment participants	Interoperability announced as mandatory from 30 June 2026	Banks, e-money issuers and payment institutions have until 30 September 2026 and microfinance institutions until 30 June 2027	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Institutions connected to PI-SPI	45 at launch (2025-09-30)	104 authorised at 31 July 2026, against 80 connected at 24 June 2026 and 74 at the end of December 2025, with Senegal (24) and Cote d'Ivoire (23) holding nearly half, ahead of Mali (14), Burkina Faso (13), Benin (11), Togo (9) and Guinea-Bissau and Niger (5 each)	ADVANCED
PI-SPI (UEMOA interoperable instant-payment platform)	In live testing from August 2025, ahead of a launch set for 30 September 2025	In service across the eight member states, free for person-to-person transfers, with banks and mobile money interconnected since May 2026	ADVANCED
Users connected to PI-SPI	Did not exist	30 million connected users and one million transactions worth 110 billion FCFA in under ten months	ADVANCED
BCEAO guide to digitalising member-state payments	In force	In force, unrevised on the record	NO CHANGE
UEMOA electronic-money issuer instruction (008-05-2015)	In force since 2015	In force since 2015: the conditions and procedures under which electronic-money issuers may operate in the member states of the monetary union	NO CHANGE
BCEAO accession to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System	BASELINE NOT HELD	A six-month pilot with more than 80 commercial banks is planned before any decision, to test conformity with the union's external-financial-relations rules	Baseline not held
EPSS (ECOWAS Payment and Settlement System)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Work is on where the platform's components will be hosted and on evaluating the central banks bidding to host them; no build, cost, timetable or legal instrument held	Baseline not held
GIM-UEMOA interbank switch	BASELINE NOT HELD	The regional interbank electronic-payments switch is running under an interim chief executive, its previous director-general having left the post he held from March 2020	Baseline not held
Union instruction on payment services	BASELINE NOT HELD	The union-wide regulatory instrument for payment services, made under the monetary union treaty and the uniform banking, microfinance and anti-money-laundering laws	Baseline not held

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.